

Over 30% of our seas protected?

A government claim, tested against EEA boundaries and EU reporting

THE CLAIM

“Malta protects more than 30% of its maritime zone...”

Environment Minister Miriam Dalli, 2025 (as quoted by Amphora Media)

ERA: “more than 35% of Malta’s Fisheries Management Zone”.

We measured the protected area from EEA maps.

VERDICT

MISLEADING

*True for one zone,
not for Malta's seas.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

4,138 km²

Protected, as stated

18 marine Natura 2000 sites, overlaps counted once (EEA).

36%

Of the fisheries zone

The 25-nautical-mile zone Malta manages.

5.5%

Of waters reported to the EU

75,715 km²: the basis for the EU's 30% target.

18,600

km² still needed

To reach 30% on the basis Malta reports to the EU.

Paper

Designation, not management

Fishing and other uses continue in Natura 2000 sites.

FAIR TO SAY

ERA's own page names the fisheries zone. The problem is the minister's "maritime zone", which reads as all of Malta's waters.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The minister's full statement.

☐ Malta's basis for the EU target.

☐ Management plans offshore.

☐ Monitoring results.